Letter Writing

Letter writing is an art. It is the commonest mode of communication. It is different from other forms of writing because it is intended for a specific reader. A letter is written when something has to be conveyed to someone sitting far away. Writing requires imagination, creativity, careful planning and organisation. The language of the letter should be interactive.

While writing a letter remember to…

Mention your intention of writing the letter in the opening paragraph. ™

Divide your letter into paragraphs, to mark changes of subject matter. ™

Include all the relevant information. Be courteous and gentle in your suggestions, even while writing a complaint. ™

Keep your sentences short. ™ Use simple English words. Use simple and direct language. ™ Avoid spelling, grammatical and careless mistakes in your letter. ™ Write neatly. ™ Be accurate,brief and precise

The Layout of a Business Letter/ An Official Letter/ Letter To The Editor

1. Sender's Name (At the top left hand corner)

2. The date (The date should be written below the address of the sender)

3. Name and the address of addressee. (The name and designation of the addressee should be on the left margin)

4. Subject (It should be an instant idea of the theme and should not be written in more than one line)

5. Salutation (Salutation is the mode of addressing a person. The usual form of salutation isi)

i)Sir or Dear Sir for individuals

ii)Sirs or Dear Sirs or Messers for companies and firms

iii)If the letter is addressed to a lady, salutation 'Madam' should be used.

6. The Body Of The Letter (Generally two or three paragraphs form the body of a letter. The first paragraph has the introduction (purpose of writing). The second one has the details about the problem or the subject (main information) and the final paragraph deals with the suggestions toward the solution of the problem.)

7. Complimentary Close (A formal letter can be ended with ‘Yours faithfully’, ‘Yours sincerely’ or ‘Yours truly’. Remember that ‘YOURS’ never takes an apostrophe and the second word is not capitalized. This element is a single word or phrase, separated from the message by a blank line.)

8. Signature (The sender’s full signature with name and designation comes at the end of a letter.) [You have to leave one line gap between various elements.]

Leave Letter

From

Kailash
I M Sc Computer Science
Department of Computer Science
Periyar University
Salem- 636011.

To

The Head of the Department
Department of Computer Science
Periyar University
Salem- 636011.

Respected Sir,

As I was suffering from fever I was unable to attend the college for the past three days (2.5.21 to 4.5.21). So please consider my absence as leave.

Thanking You,

5.5.2021
Salem.

Yours Sincerely,
Kailash

Leave Letter

From

M.Devi
I M Sc Computer Science
Department of Computer Science
Periyar University
Salem- 636011.

To

The Head of the Department
Department of Computer Science
Periyar University
Salem- 636011.

Respected Madam,

I have been unwell for the past one week due to severe food poisoning. I have become anemic due to loss of energy. Hence, I could not attend the college from 26.4.2021 to 3.5.2021. So kindly consider my seven days absence as leave.

Thanking You,

4.5.2021
Salem.

Yours Faithfully,
M.Devi

Leave Letter

From

David
I M Sc Computer Science
Department of Computer Science
Periyar University
Salem- 636011.

To

The Head of the Department
Department of Computer Science
Periyar University
Salem- 636011.

Respected Sir,

I was ill for the past two days with viral fever. I could not inform my friends about my sickness. So, I request you to pardon me for taking leave without permission and also consider my absence as leave.

Thanking You,

Yours Sincerely,

5.5.2021 David.

Salem.

[To your uncle on his 70th birthday]

18 Patel Road
Mumbai 400014
24 Sept. 2001

My dear Uncle,
I have just remembered that it is your birthday on Saturday and so I must send you a birthday letter at once And I begin with the old greeting, Many happy returns of the day ! I hope the day itself will be peaceful and happy for you and. that you will be spared in happiness and health to us all for years yet. You have always been a kind and generous uncle to me, and I take this opportunity of thanking you from the bottom of my heart for all you have done for me. And I know all your nieces and other nephews feel the same.
I was so glad to hear from father that you are still hale and hearty, and can take your fourmile walk every day, and still play a good set of tennis.

I am sending you a book which I think you will like. You were always a great reader, and I am glad that your eyesight remains as good as ever-so father says.
I am getting on well in my business and hope to enlarge it considerably before the end of the year.

With love and best wishes,
Your loving nephew,
Sohrab

[From a boy in a boarding-school to his mother, telling her that he dislikes the life of a boarder.]

St. Dominic's
Pune 411 002
24th October 2001

Dearest Mother,
I was so glad to get your letter yesterday. Thank you so much! I read it just after morning school; but it made me feel very homesick. It seems years since I left home thought it is really only about a month. It seems a month. It seems ages to the Christmas holidays, when I shall be able to come home. It was much nicer when I was at the day-school, and came home every afternoon.

I do hate being a boarder. I am in a big dormitory, with about twenty other boys. Some of them are all right; but the bigger boys are always playing nasty jokes on us smaller ones; and we daren't say anything, or we should get a most awful licking. The master comes round to see all

lights out, but all the larking goes on after he has gone; so he knows nothing about it. And I don't like the masters. They simply make you work all day, and cane you for every fault. Most of the boys are horrid; but 1 like two or three.

Please ask Dad to put me into a day-school again. I should be much happier there.

With Love,
From your loving
Tommy

[The mother's reply]

Hill-top House
Matheran
26th October, 2001

My dear Tommy,
Thank you for your letter. But I am sorry you are so unhappy at St. Dominic's. I don't wonder you feel rather homesick, for it is the first time you have been away from home; and I, too, often want you home again, my child. But you know, we can't always have what we want in life. If I were selfish, I would keep you always at home, for I don't like any of my children to be away; but then how would you ever get your education and grow up to be a man able to manage your own life ? Your father thinks that a few years at a boarding-school is necessary for all boys, to make men of them; and he knows best.

So my dear boy, you must be brave and stick to your school. I am sure you will soon get to like it, as other boys do. Don't mind the jokes boys play on you, and if you do, don't letthem know you do. When they see you don't mind, they will soon get tired of teasing you. So cheer up ! and be a brave laddie.

With much love,
From your loving
Mother

[To a friend in a hospital]

Race Cottage
Lucknow 226 003
28th December, 2001

Dear Mela Ram,
I have only just heard from your brother that you have been ill in the hospital for the last two weeks. 1 am very sorry. If I had known, I should have written before. But I am glad to know that the worst is now over, and you are much better. He says he saw you the other day, and you were quite comfortable and cheery. I hope you will soon be all right, and coming out again. As soon as you can, write and let me know how you are.

Yours very sincerely,
Sant Ram

[To a friend, about your favourite game]

I8 East Road
Junglepore
6th March, 2001

Dear Sharif,
Thanks for your letter, with your praises of cricket as the finest game in the world. I don't want to dispute that; but it is not my favourite. I have two favourite games, one for outof-doors, and one for indoors.

For exercise and interest, I like tennis best of ail outdoor games. Football and hockey are too violent to suit me; cricket is too slow; badminton is childish. But tennis gives you plenty of exercise; it develops quickness of eye and limb; and it calls your brain, your thinking power, into action. A few sets of tennis in the evening keep me physically and mentally fit.

For indoors, chess is the queen of games. 1 take no interest in card games; and draughts after chess is like water after wine. People say chess is a selfish game, because only two can play at a time. Well, I don't see that bridge is only less selfish, simply because four play instead of two. They also say it is slow. No chess-player ever says this. For an outsider it may look slow to see two men sitting silent and making a move only every few minutes. But to the two players, it is all the time intensely exciting. There is no game that so absorbs you like chess.
You will probably scoff; but I don't mind.
Yours Sincerely,
Lai Khan

[To a friend, describing a football match in which you were referee]

54 Khazanchi Road
Patna 800 004
5 Jan. 2001

Dear Devi Prasad,
My advice to those who are about to act as football referees is-Don't ! Why? Hear my sad story.

We have here two local teams called the Brilliants and the Valiants. They are easily the best teams in the district and in every tournament the fight in the end is between these two. And when their blood is up, they both fight to win, by fair means or foul- mostly foul. Moreover, the town is divided into two bitterly opposed factions-Brilliants and Valiants, who roll up, to the matches to cheer and jeer, and to see "fair" play.

The game had not long begun, before I had to turn off one of the Brilliants for foul play. The team protested, the crowd roared and things looked ugly; but I stuck to my point, and they settled down. But they were sulky. Then the Valiants scored; and the Brilliants looked sulkier still.

But the fun began when I awarded the Valiants a penalty kick close to goal, by which they promptly scored again. Then all the Brilliants rushed on to the field, yelling and shouting, and went for me. I was jostled, struck and kicked and knocked down; and the match came to an end in free fight between the two parties.

I am sitting up, nursing my wounds, and vowing, “No more refereeing for me!”

Yours in sorrow
Ahmad Din

[To a friend, from a girl who is going abroad with her father and mother.]

Jaiprakash Nagar
Goregaon
Mumbai 400 062
10th March, 2001

My dear Nora,
I am awfully excited ! My daddy and mummy are going abroad on a long tour; and I am going with them. We shall be away for about two months. We are leaving on 20th.

We are going first to Hong Kong, where my father has some business. Then we are travelling to Japan. Think of it ! I shall see the Japanese and all their interesting ways.

We shall stay there some time, and then fly to San Francisco. After that we are to travel to New York, and stay there for some time. Then we shall travel to England.
By the time we get home, I shall have seen half the world and will be a much travelled person.

I shall write you long letters from all the places we stay in and tell you of all the new and strange things we see.

With best wishes,
Very sincerely yours,
Naomi

[Letter accompanying a birthday present]

42 Ashok Marg
Lucknow 226 001
16 December 2001

My dear Charley,
It is your birthday on Saturday, so-Many happy returns of the day ! I am sending you a camera to celebrate the event, as I know you are keen on photography, and hope you will find it useful.

With all best wishes for the best of luck from your friend,
Tom

[Reply to the above.]

26 M.G. Street
Ahmedabad 380 005
18 December 2001

My dear Tom,
Ever so many thanks for your good wishes and your jolly present. The camera is a beauty-just the kind I have been wanting for a long time. I shall be able to take some really fine pictures with it. Thank you very much !

Yours affectionately,
Charley

Business Letters

Business letters should be terse, clear, and to the point. Businessmen are busy men, and have no time to read long, rambling and confused letters.

Business letters are naturally much more formal in style than friendly letters. Certain forms of polite expression are used, such as-

"I shall be much obliged if you will send me,"

"Please despatch at your earliest convenience

In business letters ordering goods, care should be taken to give clear and exact descriptions of the articles wanted. An itemized list of the goods wanted should be supplied, with the quality and quantity required.

Directions for forwarding should be given (by rail, post, etc.) and the manner in which payment will be made indicated (by Money Order, V.P.P., cheque, or by debiting to the writer's account). Everything should be clear and precise.

FORM:- The form of business letters is the same as already described, with one addition, viz., the Address (i.e., the name of the firm or businessman to whom the letter is addressed), which should be written on the first page, lower down than the Heading and to the left of the page. (It may be placed at the end of the letter lower than the signature and at the left side of the page, but the usual position is at the beginning.)

MODES OF ADDRESS:- The modes of address vary.
(1) To a tradesman:-
Shri B.V. Rao
Bookseller
12 Ring Road

Bangalore
Begin Dear Sir, and conclude Yours faithfully.

(2) To a firm:-
Messrs K.R. Das & Co.
Tea Merchants
24 Ring Road
Kolkata
Begin Dear Sirs, and conclude with Yours faithfully

Note:- If the firm has an impersonal title, Messrs should not be prefixed.

For example:-
Eurasia Publishing House, Vijay Trading Co.

(3) To professional men or private gentlemen:-
Mr. K. Bhaskar Chartered Accountant Pratibha House Thiruvananthapuram 695 002

Mr. K.R. Misra
32 Bhandarkar Road
Pune 411 004
Begin Dear Sir or My dear Sir, and conclude Yours faithfully

When a clerk signs a business letter on behalf of his employer, he puts the letter p.p. (Latin per pro = on behalf of) or for before the name of the firm, and writes his signature beneath. For example:-

Yours faithfully
For R. Gomes & Sons
K.S. Kumar

(Writing a business letter ordering furniture)

16 Church Street
Anaparthi 533 341
14 Dec. 2001

The Manager
Southern Agency
Rajahraundry 533 101

Dear Sir,
I shall be grateful if you will kindly supply the following items of Godrej furniture:
1 almirah - model 2
3 chairs - model 4

2 chairs - model 6
1 table - model 101

Please send them carriage forward to the above address, and your bill will be paid on receipt.

Yours faithfully,
V.J. Manohar

[Ordering a journal]

23PatelNagar
Gurgaon 122 001
Haryana
1 December 2001

The Business Manager
'Employment News'
East Block IV
Level-7, R.K. Puram .
New Delhi 110 066

Dear Sir,
I enclose a draft for Rs. 120 for one year's subscription to your journal Employment News. Kindly arrange to put this order into effect immediately so that I may receive the next issue.

Yours faithfully,
Abdul Rahim

(Order for books)

16 Ring Road
Ravulapalem 533 238
30 November 2001

The Manager
Sudhitha Book Centre .
Kakinada 533 001

Dear Sir,
I shall be grateful if you will send me by VPP one copy each of the following books (Collin's Retold classics, published by Messrs S. Chand & Company Ltd.) as early as possible.

1. David Copperfield

2. Huckleberry Finn
3. Treasure Island
4. Monte Cristo
5. Pickwick Papers

My address is as above.

Yours faithfully,
N. Chaitanya

(Request to the Postmaster)

46 Kingsway
Nagar 440 001
18 Jan. 2001

The Postmaster
Head Post Office
Nagpur440 001

Dear Sir,
I have recently shifted from 25 Park Street, Nagpur 440 002 to 46 Kingsway, Nagpur 440 001.1 shall be grateful if you could kindly redirect my letters to the new address.

Yours faithfully,
K. Joseph

(Letter of inquiry to an educational institution)

Desaipeta
Vetapalem 523187
21 May 2001

The Director
APTECH
4/7 Brodiepet
Guntur 522 002

Dear Sir,
I have passed the B.Sc. degree examination with Electronics as the main subject. I intend to have a course in Computer Science and would like to know the details of the courses taught at your institution. Could you please send me a copy of your prospectus?

Yours faithfully,
N. Mahesh

Activity 1

For each of the following phrases, choose the word from the list that comes closest in meaning to the word in italics. The first one is done as an example for you. Use a thesaurus wherever needed.

1. **Arduous** journey
(a) difficult (b) easy (c) interesting (d) using a vehicle

2. **Ability** to perform
(a) ease (b) capability (c) difficulty (d) machine

3. An **articulate** person
(a) beautiful (b) artistic (c) eloquent (d) irritating

4. **Doggedly**
(a) dog-like (b) animalistic (c) with a bark (d)determinedly

5. **Vibrant** session
(a) full of energy (b) enjoyable (c) interesting (d) boring

6. **Precious** metal
(a) necessary (b) regular (c) valuable (d) dangerous

7. To **assist** someone
(a) help (b) threaten (c) meet (d) stand with

8. To share a **unique** bond
(a) typical (b) simple (c) hard (d) special

9. A **vicious** animal
(a) large (b) deliberately harmful (c) friendly (d) small in size

10. To **startle**
(a) starry (b) surprise (c) terrify (d) upset

Activity 2

In each of the following sentences, a word or phrase is italicised. From the list of words/phrases given in brackets, choose the correct one that can replace the italicised word/phrase. The first one is done as an example. Again, use a thesaurus if needed.

1. The **firmament** was beautiful; looking up, we were amazed at the beauty all around us.
(a) sky (b) ceiling (c) roof (d) tall tree

2. The new game looks interesting. I'm going to **give it a try**.
(a) ignore it (b) attempt it (c) talk about it (d) play

3. Their **mansion** is **enormous**.
(a) very large (b) very small (c) well-built (d) ugly

4. The GDP of the country **shrunk** after the lockdown.
(a) increased(b) decreased (c) became famous (d) produce

5. The scientist **established** that his idea had been correct all along.
(a) decided (b) worried (c) proved (d) wrote

6. I met her when I was taking a **stroll** in the park.
(a) move (b) jog (c) walk (d) run

7. The man in the orange robe warned me that the journey to the top of the mountain could be **perilous**.
(a) easy (b) difficult (c) interesting (d) dangerous

8. I was **contemplating** calling my friend when she arrived.
(a) thinking about(b) trying to(c) beginning to (d) ignoring

9. My sister was being very **candid** about herself when she admitted that she used to be addicted to gaming.
(a) angry (b) sad (c) truthful (d) slow to speak

10. The minister **declined** the industrialist's invitation to attend the ceremony.
(a) agreed to(b) got angry with(c) refused(d) disagreed with

Find out the synonyms for the following words

1. **Abandon** means_____

a. Caught
b. Forsake

c. Bind together

2. **Accomplish** means _____
   a. Leftout
   b. Achieve
   c. Accurate
3. **Amiable** means _____
   a. Friendly
   b. Enemy
   c. Mediocre
4. **Attire** means _____
   a. Dress
   b. Money
   c. Carpet
5. **Destitute** means _____
   a. Arrongant
   b.Beautiful
   c. Penniless
6. **Cope** means ——
   a. Manage
   b. Straightforward
   c. Disaster
7. **Crash** means ——
   a. Cut
   b. Flight
   c. Accident
8. **Deter** means ——
   a. Difficult
   b. Demon
   c. Discourage
9. **Frenzy** means ——
   a. Fury
   b. Persistent

c. Comfortable

10. **Gallant** means —–
    a. Chivalrous
    b. Foolish
    c. Given
11. **Late** means —–
    a. Punctual
    b. Tardy
    c. Frozen
12. **Queer** means _____
    a. Strange
    b. Polite
    c. Distinguished
13. **Bashful** means _____
    a. Bold
    b. Bombastic
    c. Shy
14. **Spooky** means _____
    a. Scary
    b. Happy
    c. Dangerous
15. **Stroll** means_____
    a. Walk
    b. Run
    c. Crawl

Synonyms of some phrases

1. **A hell of time**- a difficult experience
2. **Achilles heel**- someone's weakness
3. **All ears** – listen carefully

4. **All hands on deck**- everyone's help is needed

5. **All the rage**- popular

6. **Ball is in your court** – the decision is up to you

7. **Beauty is in the eye of the beholder** – everyone has different perspective for what is attractive

8. **Beet red** - embarrassed or angry

9. **Stab someone in the back**- Betraying someone who trusted us

10. **Pitch in**- to contribute (give) to something or someone or to join in.

11. **Ring a bell-** somebody has mentioned something that sounds familiar to you

12. **Cut to the chase**- when someone have been talking too long and haven't gotten to the point.

13**. To go from rags to riches** - To go from being poor to having a lot of money.

14. **To have sticky fingers**- To be a thief.

15. **To go Dutch**- Everyone pays for their own meal at a restaurant.

16. **Midas touch**- To be able to make money easily.

17. **Living hand to mouth** - To live without a lot of money.

18. **Spice things up**- to make them more interesting or exciting.

19. ***A*** couch potato - someone who spends a lot of time sitting on the couch watching TV.

Vocabulary

Able	she is able to do this	**Capable**	I knew he was capable of something like this.
Wrong	Sometimes I make a mistake and do the wrong thing.	**Incorrect**	The information he gave us was incorrect.
Unmarried	He disapproves of unmarried coupl es living together.	**Single**	He will stay single all his life.
Total	We'll be on the road *for* a *total* of five days	**Entire**	You thought about it for the entire night.
Latest	Her dresses are always of the latest fashion.	**Modern**	He didn't need to understand modern science.

Rescue	I didn't need you to rescue me.	**Save**	I would give my *life* to *save* you from trouble.
Fantastic	It was fantastic!	**Great**	It's great and I love it.
Help	I couldn't help but do it.	**Assist**	She had the sudden urge to assist him.

Say	I won't say anything to anyone.	**Tell**	I tell her she must go.

Naughty	He is a *naughty* boy.	**Mischievous**	She yelled at her *mischievous* child.
Business	She runs a big *business*.	**Trade**	I was taught a *simple trade* in order to make some money.
Neat	The movie last night was really *neat.*	**Tidy**	It was tidy and empty.
Fast	He is a fast reader.	**Quick**	She took a quick step back.
End	How will it *end*?	**Finish**	Just ignore them and finish up.

Writer	He is a writer of Englishan.	**Author**	It's a famous author named Narmeen Khan.
Suggest	She suggests me take the advice.	**Propose**	How do you propose to stop them?
Alike	I and my sister looked alike to be twins.	**Same**	She does the same thing

Loud	They are getting a little loud.	**Noisy**	A noisy beggar by the road.

Trust	She trusts me.	**Believe**	I can't believe you.
Danger	Mobile res is danger for kids.	**Harm**	anything harm for us?
Keep	We must keep at least one cart.	**Hold**	There, that should hold you.
Connect	I don't need to connect the dots.	**Join**	I should join you some time.
Job	I do job for 10,000.	**Occupation**	My occupation is teaching
Shy	He asked with a shy smile.	**Bashful**	she has no respect for a bashful man.

Mistake	I made a mistake.	**Error**	You made an error.
Laugh	Don't laugh at me!	**Giggle**	She giggles like a little kid

Easy	It was easy.	**Simple**	It's a very simple idea.
Gift	I bought her some chocolates as a gift.	**Present**	He gave a *present* to my friend.
Help	*Help* them!	**Assist**	She can assist you in any way.
Quiet	She must be absolutely quiet.	**Silent**	He can no longer remain silent.
Aim	I aim to be a writer.	**Goal**	She is too close to the g*oal* to give up now

Gather	The people gathered in the square.	**Collect**	She loves *collecting* ston es at the beach
Fall	I fell down	**Drop**	Drop the pencils.
Receive	*He received* a box at work.	**Get**	Does she get up at one?
Find	*Find* a job!	**Discover**	Who discovered Am erica?
Polite	Please be polite!	**Courteous**	It was *courteous* of her to write a letter of thanks.

Extra	I need an *extra* pillow.	**Additional**	How much was the *additional* charg e?
Rich	You are *rich.*	**Wealthy**	I think she's wealthy

Buy	He decided to buy it.	**Purchase**	I want to *purchase* tickets for the festival.
Listen	Just listen to what she has to say.	**Hear**	Just hear us out.
Cunning	She gave a cunning smile as he tensed.	**Clever**	He is a clever fellow!
Sundown	Sky after sundown, more called Hesperus.	**Sunset**	I watched the sunset through the window.

tically since you left school? And if so, do you now feel that your vocabulary is somewhat limited, your verbal skills not as sharp as you would like them to be?

Let us check it out.

I challenge you to a series of tests that will measure your vocabulary range, as well as your verbal speed and responsiveness.

A TEST OF VOCABULARY RANGE

Here are sixty brief phrases, each containing one italicized word; it is up to you to check the closest definition of each such word. To keep your score valid, refrain, as far as possible, from wild guessing. The key will be found at the end of the test.

1. *disheveled* appearance: (a) untidy; (b) fierce, (c) foolish, (d) peculiar, (e) unhappy
2. a *baffling* problem: (a) difficult, (b) simple, (c) puzzling, (d) long, (e) new
3. *lenient* parent: (a) tall, (b) not strict, (c) wise, (d) foolish, (e) severe
4. *repulsive* personality: (a) disgusting, (b) attractive, (c) normal, (d) confused, (e) conceited
5. *audacious* attempt: (a) useless, (b) bold, (c) foolish, (d) crazy, (e) necessary
6. *parry* a blow: (a) ward off, (b) fear, (c) expect, (d) invite, (e) ignore
7. prevalent disease: (a) dangerous, (b) catching, (c) childhood, (d) fatal, (e) widespread
8. *ominous* report: (a) loud, (b) threatening, (c) untrue, (d) serious, (e) unpleasant
9. an *incredible* story: (a) true, (b) interesting, (c) well-known, (d) unbelievable, (e) unknown
10. an *ophthalmologist:* (a) eye doctor, (b) skin doctor, (c) foot doctor, (d) heart doctor, (e) cancer specialist
11. will *supersede* the old law: (a) enforce, (b) specify penalties for, (c) take the place of, (d) repeal, (e) continue
12. an *anonymous* donor: (a) generous, (b) stingy, (c) well-known, (d) one whose name is not known, (e) reluctant

13. performed an *autopsy:* (a) examination of living tissue, (b) examination of a corpse to determine the cause of death, (c) process in the manufacture of optical lenses, (d) operation to cure an organic disease, (e) series of questions to determine the causes of delinquent behavior
14. an *indefatigable* worker: (a) well-paid, (b) tired, (c) skillful, (d) tireless, (e) pleasant
15. a confirmed *atheist:* (a) bachelor, (b) disbeliever in God, (c) believer in religion, (d) believer in science, (e) priest
16. endless *loquacity:* (a) misery, (b) fantasy, (c) repetitiousness, (d) ill health, (e) talkativeness
17. a *glib* talker: (a) smooth, (b) awkward, (c) loud, (d) friendly, (e) boring
18. an *incorrigible* optimist: (a) happy, (b) beyond correction or reform, (c) foolish, (d) hopeful, (e) unreasonable
19. an *ocular* problem: (a) unexpected, (b) insoluble, (c) visual, (d) continual, (e) imaginary
20. a notorious *demagogue:* (a) rabble-rouser, (b) gambler, (c) perpetrator of financial frauds, (d) liar, (e) spendthrift
21. a *naïve* attitude: (a) unwise, (b) hostile, (c) unsophisticated, (d) friendly, (e) contemptuous
22. living in *affluence:* (a) difficult circumstances, (b) countrified surroundings, (c) fear, (d)wealth, (e) poverty
23. in *retrospect:* (a) view of the past, (b) artistic balance, (c) anticipation, (d) admiration, (e) second thoughts
24. a *gourmet:* (a) seasoned traveler, (b) greedy eater, (c) vegetarian, (d) connoisseur of good food, (e) skillful chef
25. to *simulate* interest: (a) pretend, (b) feel, (c) lose, (d) stir up, (e) ask for
26. a *magnanimous* action: (a) puzzling, (b) generous, (c) foolish, (d) unnecessary, (e) wise
27. a *clandestine* meeting: (a) prearranged, (b) hurried, (c) important, (d) secret, (e) public
28. the *apathetic* citizens: (a) made up of separate ethnic groups, (b) keenly vigilant of their rights, (c) politically conservative, (d) indifferent, uninterested, uninvolved, (e) terrified
29. to *placate* his son: (a) please, (b) help, (c) find a job for, (d) make arrangements for, (e) change a feeling of hostility to one of friendliness

30. to *vacillate* continually: (a) avoid, (b) swing back and forth in indecision, (c) inject, (d) treat, (e) scold
31. a *nostalgic* feeling: (a) nauseated, (b) homesick, (c) sharp, (d) painful, (e) delighted
32. feel *antipathy:* (a) bashfulness, (b) stage fright, (c) friendliness, (d) hostility, (e) suspense
33. be more *circumspect:* (a) restrained, (b) confident, (c) cautious, (d) honest, (e) intelligent
34. an *intrepid* fighter for human rights: (a) fearless, (b) eloquent, (c) popular, (d) experienced, (e) famous
35. *diaphanous* material: (a) strong, (b) sheer and gauzy, (c) colorful, (d) expensive, (e) synthetic
36. a *taciturn* host: (a) stingy, (b) generous, (c) disinclined to conversation, (d) charming, (e) gloomy
37. to *malign* his friend: (a) accuse, (b) help, (c) disbelieve, (d) slander, (e) introduce
38. a *congenital* deformity: (a) hereditary, (b) crippling, (c) slight, (d) incurable, (e) occurring at or during birth
39. a definite *neurosis:* (a) plan, (b) emotional disturbance, (c) physical disease, (d) feeling of fear, (e) allergic reaction
40. made an *unequivocal* statement: (a) hard to understand, (b) lengthy, (c) politically motivated, (d) clear and forthright, (e) supporting
41. *vicarious* enjoyment: (a) complete, (b) unspoiled, (c) occurring from a feeling of identification with another, (d) long-continuing, (e) temporary
42. *psychogenic* ailment: (a) incurable, (b) contagious, (c) originating in the mind, (d) intestinal, (e) imaginary
43. an *anachronous* attitude: (a) unexplainable, (b) unreasonable, (c) belonging to a different time, (d) out of place, (e) unusual
44. her *iconoclastic* phase: (a) artistic, (b) sneering at tradition, (c) troubled, (d) difficult, (e) religious
45. a *tyro:* (a) dominating personality, (b) beginner, (c) accomplished musician, (d) dabbler, (e) serious student
46. a *laconic* reply: (a) immediate, (b) assured, (c) terse and meaningful, (d) unintelligible, (e) angry
47. *semantic* confusion: (a) relating to the meaning of words,

(b) pertaining to money, (c) having to do with the emotions, (d) relating to mathematics, (e) caused by inner turmoil

48. *cavalier* treatment: (a) courteous, (b) haughty and high-handed, (c) negligent, (d) affectionate, (e) expensive
49. an *anomalous* situation: (a) dangerous, (b) intriguing, (c) unusual, (d) pleasant (e) unhappy
50. *posthumous* child: (a) cranky, (b) brilliant, (c) physically weak, (d) illegitimate, (e) born after the death of the father
51. feels *enervated:* (a) full of ambition, (b) full of strength, (c) completely exhausted, (d) troubled, (e) full of renewed energy
52. shows *perspicacity:* (a) sincerity, (b) mental keenness, (c) love, (d) faithfulness, (e) longing
53. an unpopular *martinet:* (a) candidate, (b) supervisor, (c) strict disciplinarian, (d) military leader, (e) discourteous snob
54. *gregarious* person: (a) outwardly calm, (b) very sociable, (c) completely untrustworthy, (d) vicious, (e) self-effacing and timid
55. generally *phlegmatic:* (a) smug, self-satisfied, (b) easily pleased, (c) nervous, high-strung, (d) emotionally unresponsive, (e) lacking in social graces
56. an *inveterate* gambler: (a) impoverished, (b) successful, (c) habitual, (d) occasional, (e) superstitious
57. an *egregious* error: (a) outstandingly bad, (b) slight, (c) irreparable, (d) unnecessary, (e) deliberate
58. *cacophony* of a large city: (a) political administration, (b) crowded living conditions, (c) cultural advantages, (d) unpleasant noises, harsh sounds, (e) busy traffic
59. a *prurient* adolescent: (a) tall and gangling, (b) sexually longing, (c) clumsy, awkward, (d) sexually attractive, (e) soft-spoken
60. *uxorious* husband: (a) henpecked, (b) suspicious, (c) guilty of infidelity, (d) fondly and foolishly doting on his wife, (e) tightfisted, penny-pinching

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KEY: 1—a, 2—c, 3—b, 4—a, 5—b, 6—a, 7—e, 8—b, 9—d, 10—a, 11—c, 12—d, 13—b, 14—d, 15—b, 16—e, 17—a, 18—b, 19—c, 20—a,

21—c, 22—d, 23—a, 24—d, 25—a, 26—b, 27—d, 28—d, 29—e, 30—b, 31—b, 32—d, 33—c, 34—a, 35—b, 36—c, 37—d, 38—e, 39—b, 40—d, 41—c, 42—c, 43—c, 44—b, 45—b, 46—c, 47—a, 48—b, 49—c, 50—e, 51—c, 52—b, 53—c, 54—b, 55—d, 56—c, 57—a, 58—d, 59—b, 60—d

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Your score (one point for each correct choice): _____

The Meaning of Your Score:

0—11:	below average
12—35:	average
36—48:	above average
49—54:	excellent
55—60:	superior

A TEST OF VERBAL SPEED

PART 1

This is a timed test.

In no more than three minutes (time yourself, or have someone time you), decide whether the word in column B is the *same* (or *approximately the same*) in meaning as the word in column A; *opposite* (or *approximately opposite*) in meaning; or whether the two words are merely *different*.

Circle S for *same*, O for *opposite*, and D for *different*.

You will not have time to dawdle or think too long, so go as fast as you can.

COLUMN A	COLUMN B			
1. sweet	sour	S	O	D
2. crazy	insane	S	O	D
3. stout	fat	S	O	D
4. big	angry	S	O	D
5. danger	peril	S	O	D
6. help	hinder	S	O	D

7.	splendid	magnificent	S	O	D
8.	love	hate	S	O	D
9.	stand	rise	S	O	D
10.	furious	violent	S	O	D
11.	tree	apple	S	O	D
12.	doubtful	certain	S	O	D
13.	handsome	ugly	S	O	D
14.	begin	start	S	O	D
15.	strange	familiar	S	O	D
16.	male	female	S	O	D
17.	powerful	weak	S	O	D
18.	beyond	under	S	O	D
19.	live	die	S	O	D
20.	go	get	S	O	D
21.	return	replace	S	O	D
22.	growl	weep	S	O	D
23.	open	close	S	O	D
24.	nest	home	S	O	D
25.	chair	table	S	O	D
26.	want	desire	S	O	D
27.	can	container	S	O	D
28.	idle	working	S	O	D
29.	rich	luxurious	S	O	D
30.	building	structure	S	O	D

PART 2

This is also a timed test.

In no more than three minutes (again, time yourself or have someone time you), write down as many *different* words as you can think of that start with the letter *D*.

Do *not* use various forms of a word, such as *do, doing, does, done, doer,* etc.

Space is provided for 125 words. You are not expected to reach that number, but write as fast as you can and see how many blanks you can fill in before your time is up.

1. _____